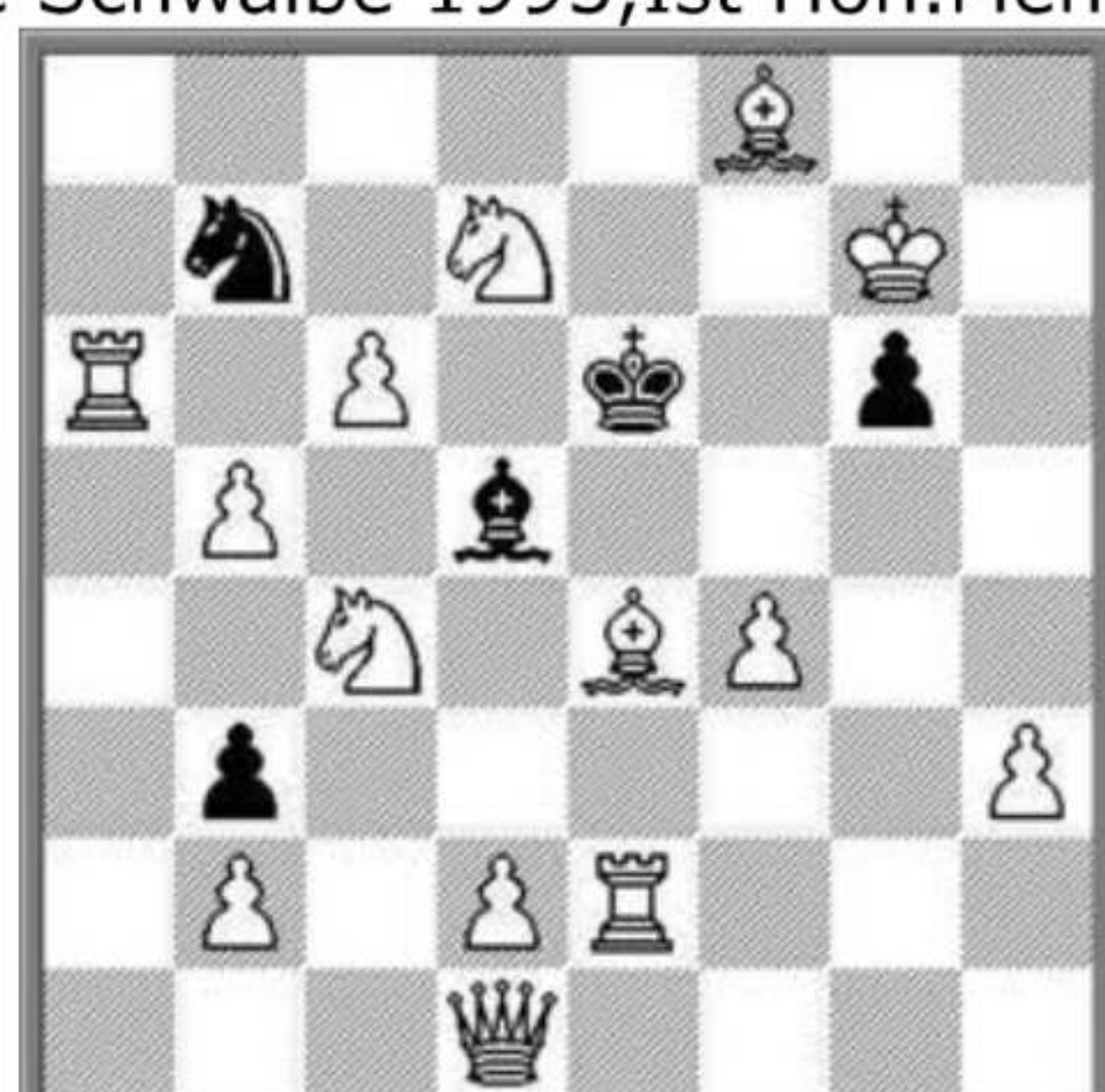


An unsung classic revisited

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Very rarely a two-mover presenting a task record combines traditional and modern themes. The problem below by a pair of Ukrainian GMs combine cyclic refutation, Salazar and secondary Schiffmann. This was featured in 'Oz chess problems' an Australian website by Peter Wong with his comments.

Ian Soroka and Vasyl Dyachuk
Die Schwalbe 1993, Ist Hon. Mention



Mate in two moves

Three tries generate the cyclic refutation-After 1.Qh1? (waiting), the queen targets the potential flight on d5, 1...Bxe4 [a] 2.Qxe4, 1...Bxc4 [b] 2.Bd3, but this is defeated by 1...Bxc6! [c]. The second try 1.Sce5? [A] (waiting) adds a guard on d7, 1...Bc4 [b] 2.cxb7, 1...Bxc6 [c] (self-pin) 2.Qxb3 [C], but 1...Bxe4! [a] is unanswered. Thirdly, 1.Sd6? [B] controls f5 and threatens 2.Bf5, 1...Bxc6 [c] 2.Bxc6, 1...Bxe4 [a] (self-pin) 2.Qxb3 [C], but 1...Bc4! [b] refutes. Key **1.Qxb3!** [C]

1...Bxe4 [a](selfpin) **2.Sd6** [B], **1...Bxc4** [b] **2.Qxc4**

1...Bxc6 [c](selfpin) **2.Sce5** [A]

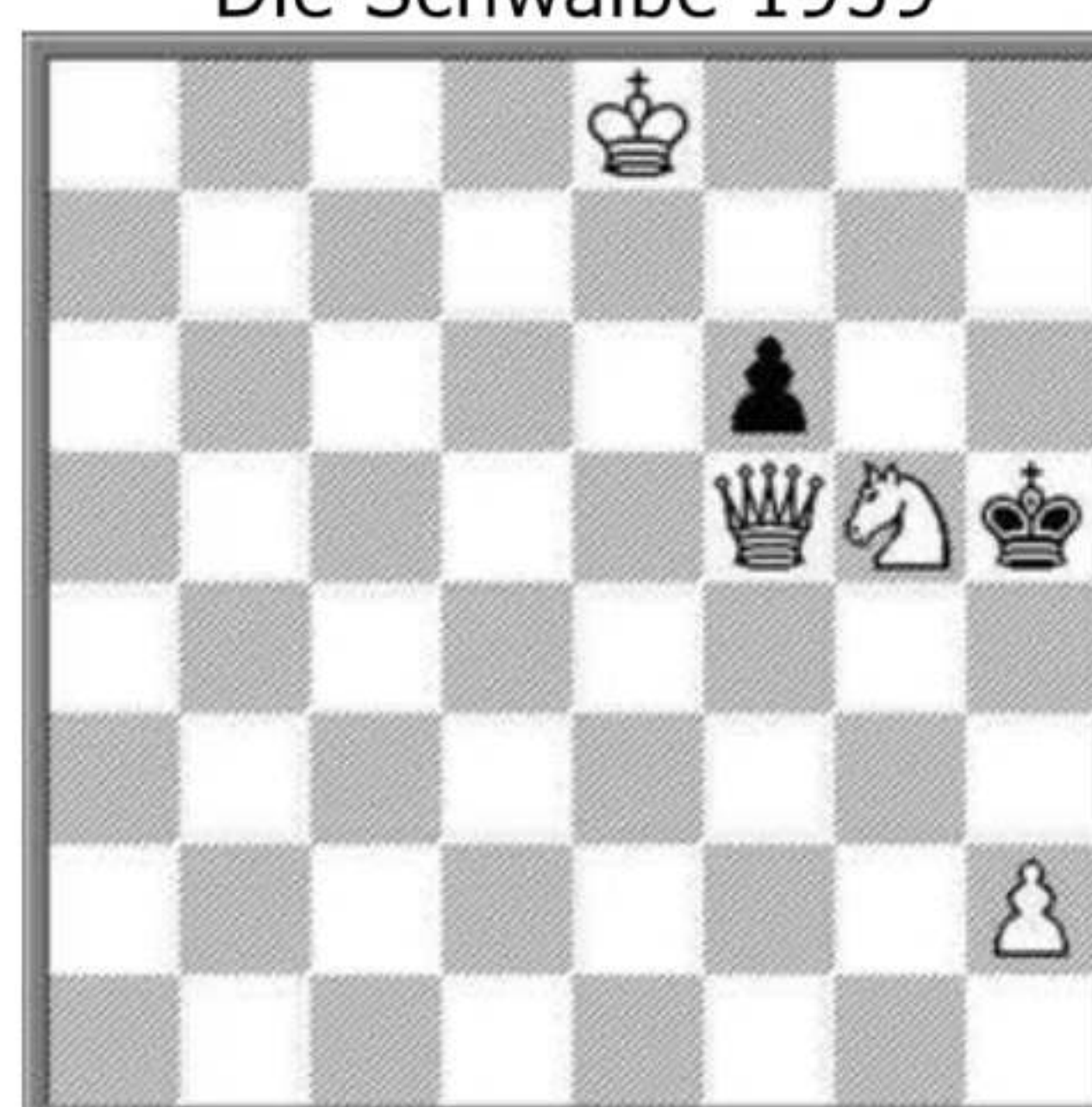
Since in the post-key play, all three mating moves against the bishop defences are changed yet again, the maximum nine distinct variations are

achieved to complete a cyclic refutation.

Further two *sequence reversals* are incorporated in the full solution, as indicated by the white moves marked [A/B/C]. The try play 1.Sce5? [A] Bxc6 2.Qxb3 [C] and actual play 1.Qxb3! [C] Bxc6 2.Sce5 [A] see a reversal of White's first and second moves, against the same defence. Such a pattern, which involves the same mating picture arising from battery and non-battery play, is called the Salazar theme. A similar reversal, 1.Sd6? [B] Bxe4 2.Qxb3 [C] and 1.Qxb3! [C] Bxe4 2.Sd6 [B], means that the idea is doubled. This complex blend of cyclic and reciprocal pattern themes is enhanced by traditional effects like the three firing batteries and self-pinning defences. IM N.Shankar Ram points out a secondary Schiffmann also in this problem. I feel this classic was not appropriately honoured considering the very rich content.

A miniature cyclic refutation for solving

Nils van Dijk
Die Schwalbe 1959



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article' Play by the white queen':
Key: 1.Qg7! (2.Qe5+ Rxe5 3.dxe5)
1...Rxd5 2.Qg5 (3.Nf2) Rxd5 3.d5
1...Bxd5 2.Qf7 Bxf7 3.d5; 1...Qxd5
2.Qb7 (3.Qb1) Qxb7 3.d5 Three active sacrifices of White queen

Readers may send in their queries to
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